

Sila Nanotechnologies

Next-Gen Battery Materials (silicon anode) · Alameda, CA · Private (~\$3.3B; first auto-scale silicon-anode plant live)

Sila Nanotechnologies - the silicon-anode leader (~\$3.3B) whose Titan Silicon lifts battery energy density, with the first auto-scale plant live and a Tesla-founder CEO - has never been in motorsport, and energy density is the defining constraint of electric racing.

72

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

WARM

SERIES

FE

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Nissan Formula E

ACTION HORIZON

8-12 WKS

THE CASE

Sila Nanotechnologies, the next-gen battery-materials leader (~\$3.3B; \$1.31B raised, incl. a \$375M Series G, from Sutter Hill, Bessemer, Coatue), makes Titan Silicon - a silicon anode that raises lithium-ion energy density - and in Sep 2025 opened the first US auto-scale silicon-anode plant (Moses Lake, WA), now shipping to Mercedes-Benz, BMW and Panasonic. Its founder-CEO, Gene Berdichevsky, was Tesla employee #7 and led the original Roadster battery - a marquee, motorsport-adjacent story. It has never entered motorsport. Battery energy density is the single defining constraint of electric racing, so a silicon-anode leader is unusually on-message for Formula E. HONEST framing: FE's race battery is a single spec/series supplier, so Sila's anode is a series-level input rather than a team-deployable workstream - the team value is brand, a battery-innovation narrative and a talent halo (MODE B), scored WARM accordingly. Decision-maker: CEO & co-founder Gene Berdichevsky.

WHY NOW

Sila just brought the first auto-scale silicon-anode plant online and is ramping series production with marquee automakers, so its profile and brand are rising - and electric racing is the most on-message stage for a battery-energy-density story. The honest 'why now' is the production milestone plus a pre-IPO brand window, not a forcing FE event.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

~\$3.3B

Valuation (recent private-market data; \$1.31B raised)

Moses Lake, Sep 2025

First US auto-scale silicon-anode plant opened (supports ~500k vehicles/yr)

\$375M

Series G round (Jun 2024; Sutter Hill, Bessemer, Coatue)

Gene Berdichevsky

Co-Founder & CEO (Tesla employee #7; Roadster battery lead)

Titan Silicon

Product (raises lithium-ion energy density; ships to Mercedes/BMW/Panasonic)

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE FE GRID (1440 TEAM-FIT ENGINE)

Nissan	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Andretti	CROWDED	TWG AI, Quest Global, NAGASE
Porsche	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Jaguar TCS Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

Next-gen battery-materials leader (~\$3.3B; \$1.31B raised) - its Titan Silicon anode lifts energy density, the core constraint of electric racing - and it opened the first auto-scale silicon-anode plant (Moses Lake, Sep 2025), shipping to Mercedes, BMW and Panasonic. Founder-CEO Gene Berdichevsky was Tesla employee #7 and led the Roadster battery - a marquee motorsport-adjacent story. HONEST: the in-car battery is a series/spec supplier, so this is brand + battery-innovation narrative (MODE-B-leaning), scored WARM.

- NEVER ENTERED
- FUNDING EVENT
- CATEGORY WHITESPACE
- DISCOVERY: SELF

WHY NISSAN FORMULA E

Nissan's Formula E team is a works EV pioneer with an open battery-innovation/clean-energy lane (its partners are powertrain, electronics and ESG, not battery materials), so a silicon-anode energy-density story is on-brand. The value is brand + battery-innovation narrative, not a car-technology deployment.

VALUE TO NISSAN FORMULA E — MODE B (TECH SERVES THE TEAM OPERATION)

MODE B - concrete mechanics, honestly bounded. (1) BRAND / NARRATIVE: 'the battery breakthrough that makes electric go further' on the electric racing series is an ownable, on-message co-marketing story, amplified by a Tesla-Roadster-battery founder - genuinely distinctive, not a logo. (2) CONTENT / TECH: a co-developed content series on battery energy density and the future of EVs (the exact thing FE exists to advance) is credible fan- and sponsor-facing material. (3) TALENT / ECOSYSTEM: a battery/materials-engineering recruiting halo and access to Sila's automaker network (Mercedes/BMW). Nissan gets a marquee battery-innovation brand partner and standout content; Sila gets a global stage for its energy-density story. (Scored honestly: the race battery is spec/series-supplied, so this is brand/content/talent value, not an in-car deployment.)

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Brand / Innovation Partner on Nissan Formula E, minimum three years, value-tier (~\$2-4M/yr), centred on a battery-energy-density co-marketing and content programme plus a talent/ecosystem tie-in - explicitly a brand partnership, not a technical supply deal.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Gene Berdichevsky
CO-FOUNDER & CEO, SILA NANOTECHNOLOGIES - VERIFIED
(TESLA EMPLOYEE #7; LED THE ROADSTER BATTERY)

Co-founder and CEO with marquee EV-battery pedigree (Tesla #7, Roadster battery lead) - the owner of brand/partnership decisions and a credible motorsport-adjacent face. Decision path: Berdichevsky (brand/strategy) with the marketing/comms leadership as activation counterpart; confirm the brand lead before outreach.

OPENING ANGLE

"Gene - you built Tesla's first battery, and Formula E is where battery energy density is proven in public. As Moses Lake ramps and you build toward an IPO, 'the silicon that makes electric go further' on Nissan is a story only you can tell. 25 minutes?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 15 / 20 Opened the first US auto-scale silicon-anode plant (Moses Lake, Sep 2025) and is ramping series production for Mercedes/BMW/Panasonic - a real production-scale milestone window.	CAPACITY 16 / 20 ~\$3.3B valuation, \$1.31B raised, GWh-scale production live - solid capacity for a value-to-mid tier.	BRAND FIT 16 / 20 Battery energy density is the defining constraint of electric racing, so a silicon-anode leader is maximally on-message, and Berdichevsky's Tesla-Roadster-battery pedigree resonates.	URGENCY 12 / 20 Production ramp and IPO potential, but no dated FE trigger, and battery is a contested grid category.	OPS FIT 13 / 20 MODE B leaning: FE's battery is a single spec/series supplier, so Sila's anode is a series-level input, not a team workstream - the team value is brand + battery-innovation narrative + talent.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

BATTERY IS A CONTESTED CATEGORY Battery-materials/cells partners sit at Mahindra (Umicore) and Envision (AESC). **Counter:** Position Sila on the energy-density innovation narrative on Nissan (where the lane is open), not as a grid-wide battery claim; it's brand-led.

RACE BATTERY IS SPEC/SERIES-SUPPLIED Sila's anode can't be a team in-car workstream. **Counter:** Scored MODE-B; name the concrete brand/content/talent mechanics rather than implying an in-car deployment.

PRE-IPO SPEND DISCIPLINE Capital is going into the Moses Lake ramp, not marketing. **Counter:** Right-size to a value tier with a brand-build rationale tied to the production milestone.

SOURCES

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